

DSAT Practice — Detail (According to the Text)

25 Solutions with Reasoning, Trap Alerts & Insights

Q1. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: The text explicitly states that Kepler detects exoplanets by monitoring brightness dips caused by transits—planets passing in front of stars.

WHY WRONG: **A)** Direct imaging is not described. | **B)** Spectroscopy is not mentioned. | **C)** Gravitational waves are not mentioned.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *B tempts students familiar with atmospheric spectroscopy, but the text only describes the transit method.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *'According to the text' questions require you to find the answer stated in the passage, not use outside knowledge.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Transit = brightness dip = A.*

Q2. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: The text says gravel 'represents flowing water' and rocks 'symbolize mountains or islands'—both abstract suggestions of natural elements.

WHY WRONG: **B)** Maintenance is not discussed. | **C)** The text explicitly says they do NOT replicate landscapes literally. | **D)** The text says visitors view from a fixed vantage point, not walk through.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *C is a direct contradiction of the passage; watch for 'NOT' language.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *'Represent' and 'symbolize' = abstraction, not literal replication.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Represent water + symbolize mountains = abstract suggestion = A.*

Q3. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: The text defines neoteny as 'retains its larval features throughout its life—a condition known as neoteny.'

WHY WRONG: **A)** Regeneration is described separately from neoteny. | **C)** The text says the axolotl remains fully aquatic; no transition is described. | **D)** Unusual size is not mentioned.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *B tempts because regeneration is the axolotl's most famous trait, but the text clearly defines neoteny as retaining larval features.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *Look for the dash or parenthetical that follows the term—that's the definition.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *'Retains larval features... known as neoteny' = A.*

Q4. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: The text states companies 'did not experience a decrease in overall productivity, as employees tended to work more efficiently.'

WHY WRONG: **A)** Industry variation is not mentioned. | **B)** The text does not say all companies adopted the model permanently. | **C)** No initial decline is described.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *B overstates the finding; the text says no productivity loss, not dramatic increase.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *'Did not experience a decrease' is not the same as 'increased dramatically.'*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *No decrease + more efficient = A.*

Q5. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: The text says '30,000 clay tablets inscribed with cuneiform script.'

WHY WRONG: **A)** Papyrus is not mentioned. | **C)** Silk is not mentioned. | **D)** Parchment is not mentioned.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *B tempts students who associate ancient writing with papyrus, but this is Mesopotamian, not Egyptian.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *Detail questions often have one correct answer directly stated and three that use outside-knowledge associations.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *'Clay tablets' = A.*

Q6. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: The text says 'cold air masses move across large bodies of warm water. As the air absorbs moisture and heat from the lake surface...' This is the direct cause described.

WHY WRONG: **A)** The text says warm water, not frozen surfaces. | **B)** Mountain deflection is not described. | **C)** Ocean currents are not mentioned; this is about lake effect.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *D tempts because cold weather is associated with frozen lakes, but the phenomenon requires warm water surfaces.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *The key mechanism is cold air + warm water = moisture absorption.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Cold air + warm lake = moisture = snow = A.*

Q7. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: 'Because scholars could already read ancient Greek, they used the Greek text as a key to decipher the hieroglyphic script.'

WHY WRONG: **B)** The text does not say Greek was the oldest script. | **C)** The text says the same decree appears in all three—no additional information in Greek. | **D)** Champollion is not described as a Greek speaker.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *C tempts because students might assume the key had extra information, but its value was readability, not unique content.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *The Greek text was useful because it was already understood, not because it contained different information.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Already readable → used as key = A.*

Q8. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: The text says 'the eagle alarm causes monkeys to look up or hide in low bushes.'

WHY WRONG: A) Remaining motionless is not described for any alarm. | **B)** Climbing trees is the response to the leopard alarm, not the eagle alarm. | **D)** Producing additional calls is not described.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *B is the classic DSAT trap: it takes information from the passage but applies it to the wrong alarm call.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *Match the specific alarm (eagle) to the specific response (look up/low bushes), not to other responses in the passage.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Eagle alarm → look up or low bushes = A.*

Q9. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: The text says household income 'did not increase significantly compared to control groups.' This means microloans did not lead to a meaningful income increase.

WHY WRONG: A) No short-term increase followed by losses is described. | **B)** Regulatory frameworks are not discussed. | **D)** The text says recipients did invest in businesses—so there was some economic effect, just not on income.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *D overstates: the text says income didn't increase significantly, but recipients did invest—so there was an effect on behavior, just not on income.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *'Did not increase significantly compared to control' = no meaningful difference = A.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *No significant increase vs. control = A.*

Q10. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: The 'prevailing view' attributes alignments to astronomy (solstices, equinoxes); Gallagher attributes them to landscape features (mountain passes, river valleys). Choice A captures this difference.

WHY WRONG: A) Gallagher argues for deliberate alignment to landscape features, not random placement. | **B)** Defensive purposes are not mentioned. | **C)** Dating of construction is not discussed.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *D tempts because Gallagher challenges the astronomical interpretation, but he replaces it with landscape-based intentional alignment, not randomness.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *Gallagher substitutes one explanation (astronomy) with another (landscape), not with no explanation.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Stars → landscape features = A.*

Q11. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: The text says mantas 'actively seek out areas of high zooplankton density, adjusting their swimming depth and trajectory.' This is deliberate targeting, not passive feeding.

WHY WRONG: A) Night feeding is not described; the text says consistent times of day without specifying night. | **B)** Competition with other species is not mentioned. | **D)** No other food types are mentioned.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *C tempts because students may associate deep-sea feeding with nighttime, but the text doesn't specify night.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *'Actively seek out' = deliberate, not passive.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Active seeking + adjusting trajectory = deliberate targeting = A.*

Q12. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: Tanaka says the policy creates 'a large constituency of beneficiaries... who have a vested interest in maintaining and expanding the program. This constituency then exerts political pressure.'

WHY WRONG: B) International treaties are not mentioned. | **C)** Administrative costs are not discussed. | **D)** Voter ignorance is not cited.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *C tempts because it sounds like a plausible reason, but it's not in the text.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *'Vested interest' + 'political pressure' = A.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Beneficiaries → political pressure → hard to repeal = A.*

Q13. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: The text says 'tiles are angled so that rainwater is channeled into a central collection basin for use in irrigating the surrounding gardens.'

WHY WRONG: A) Insulation is not mentioned. | **B)** Electricity generation is not described. | **D)** Wind resistance is not discussed.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *B tempts because angled tiles might suggest solar panels, but the text specifies water channeling.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *Read for stated function, not inferred function.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Angled tiles → rain → basin → irrigation = A.*

Q14. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: For the most challenging anagrams, 'performance was equivalent across both groups'—meaning music provided no advantage.

WHY WRONG: B) The text says the opposite: music helped only on moderate difficulty. | **C)** Performance was equivalent, not impaired. | **D)** Abandoning the task is not described.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *B reverses the finding; music helped on moderate puzzles, not difficult ones.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *'Equivalent' = no difference = no improvement.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Most difficult: equivalent performance = no benefit = A.*

Q15. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: El-Amine presents evidence that coffeehouses 'functioned as informal academies' and argues they were 'a critical but underappreciated institution in the Ottoman intellectual ecosystem.' This challenges the 'leisure and socializing' characterization.

WHY WRONG: A) While administrators are mentioned, El-Amine's argument is broader than government business. | **C)** Comparison with European coffeehouses is not made. | **D)** No decline is discussed.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *B narrows the argument too much; El-Amine includes poets and scholars, not just officials.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *'Contrary to the widespread characterization' signals the main argument is about reframing perception.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Not just social → intellectual centers = A.*

Q16. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: The text says wasp larvae 'initially avoid consuming the beetle's vital organs, keeping the host alive—and therefore fresh.' The dash introduces the reason: freshness.

WHY WRONG: A) Toxins are not mentioned. | **C)** The beetle's immune system is not discussed. | **D)** Size is not cited as the reason.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *D tempts because early-stage larvae are small, but the text explicitly connects organ avoidance to keeping the host fresh.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *The dash ('—and therefore fresh—') signals the purpose clause.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Avoid organs → host alive → fresh tissue = A.*

Q17. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: Spanish speakers used 'delicate/elegant' for la llave (feminine); German speakers used 'sturdy/heavy' for der Schlüssel (masculine). Adjective choices corresponded to grammatical gender.

WHY WRONG: B) They described the same object (key) differently, not different objects identically. | **C)** The two groups used different adjective types, not both masculine-associated. | **D)** Abstract vs. concrete adjective distinction is not described.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *B reverses the finding: same object, different adjectives (not different objects, same adjectives).*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *Same object + different adjectives aligned with grammatical gender = A.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Feminine key → delicate; masculine key → sturdy = gender shapes perception = A.*

Q18. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: 'The device's output drops significantly on overcast days, limiting its reliability in regions with extended cloudy seasons.'

WHY WRONG: B) The text says no chemical additives are required. | **C)** 20 liters/hour meets a family of four's needs. | **D)** The text says no replacement filters are needed.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *B and D are direct contradictions of the passage—the device specifically avoids chemicals and filters.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *Limitations are usually introduced with 'however,' 'notes,' or 'cautions.'*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Overcast days → output drops → limited reliability = A.*

Q19. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: Professionals activated the FFA for chess positions while novices did not. Mehta's hypothesis is that practice repurposed the FFA for holistic pattern recognition analogous to face recognition. This implies the FFA has been co-opted for chess through training.

WHY WRONG: A) Facial recognition of opponents is not discussed. | **C)** The text says novices showed no significant FFA activation, not equivalent activation. | **D)** The text posits an analogy between chess and face recognition, not identical function.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *C directly contradicts the text (no FFA activation in novices).*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *'Analogous to' = similar process, different domain. The FFA is repurposed, not used identically.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *FFA active in experts only + analogy to face recognition = repurposed through practice = A.*

Q20. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: Okafor says the restrained style 'mirrors the communal, oral storytelling traditions' and 'reproduces the communal narrator's expectation that listeners will draw their own moral conclusions.' So the purpose is cultural fidelity to Igbo oral tradition.

WHY WRONG: **A)** Translation ease is not discussed. | **B)** Limited familiarity with Western conventions is not suggested. | **D)** The narrator's disapproval is not implied; the restraint is about letting readers judge.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *D tempts because readers might project disapproval onto the narrator's silence, but Okafor explicitly says the restraint allows listeners to draw their own conclusions.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *'Cultural fidelity' = the style matches the tradition it depicts.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Restrained style → mirrors oral tradition → readers draw own conclusions = A.*

Q21. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: Watanabe argues the iridium 'may represent a combined signature of both events rather than an exclusively asteroidal one.' He's not denying the asteroid but adding volcanism as a contributor.

WHY WRONG: **A)** Watanabe does not dispute that the Chicxulub impact occurred. | **C)** Watanabe says 'combined signature,' not volcanism alone. | **D)** Watanabe's argument presupposes iridium IS present at the boundary.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *C overstates Watanabe's claim; he proposes shared contribution, not sole volcanic origin.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *'Combined signature of both events' = both contributed, not one exclusively.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Not exclusively asteroidal → volcanic contribution too = A.*

Q22. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: Near-railroad districts had higher average income BUT greater inequality—benefits concentrated among landowners/merchants, not subsistence farmers. So gains were unevenly distributed.

WHY WRONG: **A)** The text describes uneven distribution, not uniform benefits. | **B)** The text says the opposite: farmers saw little improvement; landowners/merchants benefited. | **C)** The text says near-railroad districts had greater inequality, not less.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *D directly contradicts the passage. C reverses the inequality finding.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *'However' signals the nuance: higher average income BUT concentrated gains.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Higher average + greater inequality + concentrated benefits = unevenly distributed = A.*

Q23. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: Highly engaged participants 'showed no change, suggesting a ceiling effect.' This means the documentary did not increase their willingness to pay because they were already at maximum.

WHY WRONG: **A)** They showed no change, not the largest increase. | **B)** They were not excluded; their data is reported. | **C)** No decrease is described; they 'showed no change.'

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *D is the exact opposite of the finding; it confuses highly engaged participants with low-engagement ones.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *'Ceiling effect' means you can't go higher because you're already at the top.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Highly engaged + no change = ceiling effect = A.*

Q24. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: The text says piezolipids 'remain flexible under pressures that would rigidify the membranes of surface-dwelling bacteria, causing cell death.' So piezolipids prevent fatal rigidity.

WHY WRONG: **A)** Metabolic energy generation is not described. | **C)** Genetic protection is not mentioned. | **D)** Photosynthesis is not discussed.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *B tempts because deep-sea survival might suggest energy mechanisms, but the text specifically describes membrane flexibility.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *The text defines the mechanism precisely: flexibility under pressure prevents rigidity and death.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Flexible membranes under pressure → survival = A.*

Q25. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: Chakraborty demonstrates that 'sculptures depicting benevolent deities consistently use copper-rich alloys (green patinas), while fierce deities use tin-rich alloys (brown patinas)—a pattern too systematic to be coincidental.' This consistent correspondence is her evidence.

WHY WRONG: **A)** The text shows different alloys for different deities, not identical compositions. | **B)** No written workshop records are mentioned. | **D)** No comparison with contemporary sculptors is made.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *C directly contradicts the evidence; the whole point is that alloy compositions differ systematically.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *'Too systematic to be coincidental' = the pattern itself is the evidence for intentionality.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Copper-rich → green → benevolent; tin-rich → brown → fierce = systematic pattern = A.*

TOPIC SUMMARY

TOP 3 MISTAKES — Detail:

1. Selecting an answer that uses correct details from the passage but applies them to the wrong entity (e.g., eagle alarm response applied to leopard alarm).
2. Choosing an answer that seems plausible based on outside knowledge but is not supported by the passage.
3. Overstating or understating the passage's claim (e.g., 'no measurable effect' when the text says 'no significant increase').

TOP 3 RULES:

1. Return to the passage for every detail question; do not rely on memory or outside knowledge.
2. Match the scope of the answer to the scope of the passage: if the passage says 'partially,' reject answers that say 'completely.'
3. Pay attention to qualifiers ('may,' 'suggests,' 'tends to') that limit the strength of a claim.

EXPECTED FREQUENCY: 3–5 questions per module. Detail/inference questions are the backbone of the Reading portion.